

Retail and E-Commerce English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: retail managers, e-commerce teams, merchandising staff, store operations leaders, fulfillment teams, customer service managers, marketplace sellers, and growth operators

Focus: A retail and e-commerce English curriculum for merchandising, pricing, inventory, fulfillment, marketplaces, customer complaints, returns, conversion metrics, promotions, and vendor coordination.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Situation

A buyer wants to add many new SKUs before holiday season.

Stakeholder pressure: Approve the assortment expansion.

Constraint: Shelf space, demand signal, margin, inventory risk, and vendor capacity need review.

Terms to use

- assortment
- SKU
- sell-through
- gross margin

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A buyer wants to add many new SKUs before holiday season.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Approve the assortment expansion.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects SKU.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a assortment decision memo.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects SKU.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	SKU
C	assortment
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Approve the assortment expansion.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify assortment and SKU against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	A assortment decision memo is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A buyer wants to add many new SKUs before holiday season. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the assortment decision memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 2. Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Situation

A promotion drives revenue but margin falls sharply.

Stakeholder pressure: Repeat the promotion because sales increased.

Constraint: Gross margin, cannibalization, inventory, customer acquisition, and brand impact matter.

Terms to use

- markdown
- promotion
- gross margin
- cannibalization

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A promotion drives revenue but margin falls sharply.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Repeat the promotion because sales increased.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects promotion.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a promotion readout.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects promotion.

Option	Phrase
A	promotion
B	gross margin
C	markdown
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Repeat the promotion because sales increased.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify markdown and promotion against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A promotion drives revenue but margin falls sharply. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	evidence threshold
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the promotion readout with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 3. Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

Situation

A hot item is stocked out in stores but overstocked online.

Stakeholder pressure: Transfer everything immediately.

Constraint: Allocation, demand, lead time, logistics cost, and service level require planning.

Terms to use

- allocation
- replenishment
- stockout

- inventory turn

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A hot item is stocked out in stores but overstocked online.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Transfer everything immediately.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects replenishment.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a replenishment action plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects replenishment.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	allocation
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Transfer everything immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A replenishment action plan is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify allocation and replenishment against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A hot item is stocked out in stores but overstocked online. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the replenishment action plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path

Option	Phrase
D	operating constraint

Module 4. Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

Situation

A warehouse backlog delays guaranteed delivery dates.

Stakeholder pressure: Send a general apology.

Constraint: Order status, carrier capacity, customer promise, refund policy, and service recovery matter.

Terms to use

- fulfillment
- SLA
- return rate
- carrier

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A warehouse backlog delays guaranteed delivery dates.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Send a general apology.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects SLA.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a fulfillment delay script.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects SLA.

Option	Phrase
A	fulfillment
B	return rate
C	carrier
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Send a general apology.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold

Option	Phrase
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify fulfillment and SLA against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A warehouse backlog delays guaranteed delivery dates. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the fulfillment delay script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 5. Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

Situation

Checkout conversion drops after a redesign.

Stakeholder pressure: Assume customers dislike the new look.

Constraint: Instrumentation, device mix, payment errors, and funnel step drop-off need analysis.

Terms to use

- conversion rate
- funnel
- cart abandonment
- A/B test

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Checkout conversion drops after a redesign.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Assume customers dislike the new look.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects funnel.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a conversion diagnosis.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects funnel.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	conversion rate
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Assume customers dislike the new look.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve conversion rate after the result is visible.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify conversion rate and funnel against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Checkout conversion drops after a redesign. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the conversion diagnosis with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	evidence threshold

Module 6. Marketplace and Vendor Management

Situation

A vendor ships late and product ratings fall.

Stakeholder pressure: Threaten to delist them immediately.

Constraint: Scorecards, SLA, customer impact, inventory, and remediation plan need review.

Terms to use

- marketplace
- vendor scorecard
- SLA
- defect rate

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A vendor ships late and product ratings fall.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Threaten to delist them immediately.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects vendor scorecard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a vendor scorecard update.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects vendor scorecard.

Option	Phrase
A	marketplace
B	decision owner
C	vendor scorecard
D	SLA

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Threaten to delist them immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify marketplace and vendor scorecard against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A vendor ships late and product ratings fall. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the vendor scorecard update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Option	Phrase
D	operating constraint

Module 7. Customer Service and Escalations

Situation

A customer demands a refund outside the return window.

Stakeholder pressure: Make an exception for anyone who complains loudly.

Constraint: Policy, goodwill, fraud risk, and customer lifetime value need balanced judgment.

Terms to use

- return policy
- goodwill credit
- chargeback
- customer lifetime value

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A customer demands a refund outside the return window.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Make an exception for anyone who complains loudly.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects goodwill credit.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a escalation response.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects goodwill credit.

Option	Phrase
A	return policy
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Make an exception for anyone who complains loudly.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify return policy and goodwill credit against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	We should act now and resolve return policy after the result is visible.
D	A escalation response is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A customer demands a refund outside the return window. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the escalation response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 8. Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

Situation

Buy-online-pickup-in-store orders are not ready on time.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell stores to prioritize online orders over walk-ins.

Constraint: Labor, inventory accuracy, queue management, and customer expectations all matter.

Terms to use

- BOPIS
- inventory accuracy
- queue
- labor model

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Buy-online-pickup-in-store orders are not ready on time.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell stores to prioritize online orders over walk-ins.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects inventory accuracy.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a omnichannel operations brief.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects inventory accuracy.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	BOPIS

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell stores to prioritize online orders over walk-ins.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve BOPIS after the result is visible.
B	A omnichannel operations brief is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify BOPIS and inventory accuracy against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Buy-online-pickup-in-store orders are not ready on time. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the omnichannel operations brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Merchandising and Assortment Planning - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. assortment	'assortment' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Merchandising and Assortment Planning - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify assortment and SKU against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Merchandising and Assortment Planning - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the assortment decision memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Pricing, Promotions, and Margin - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. markdown	'markdown' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Pricing, Promotions, and Margin - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify markdown and promotion against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Pricing, Promotions, and Margin - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the promotion readout with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. allocation	'allocation' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify allocation and replenishment against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the replenishment action plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. fulfillment	'fulfillment' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify fulfillment and SLA against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the fulfillment delay script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. conversion rate	'conversion rate' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify conversion rate and funnel against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the conversion diagnosis with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Marketplace and Vendor Management - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. marketplace	'marketplace' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Marketplace and Vendor Management - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify marketplace and vendor scorecard against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Marketplace and Vendor Management - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the vendor scorecard update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Customer Service and Escalations - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. return policy	'return policy' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Customer Service and Escalations - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify return policy and goodwill credit against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Customer Service and Escalations - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the escalation response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. BOPIS	'BOPIS' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify BOPIS and inventory accuracy against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the omnichannel operations brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.